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9500 GILMAN DRIVE
LA JOLLA, CALIFORNIA 92093-0348

Student Evaluation of Teaching (SET) for Lucy Lai

Winter 2026 COGS 180 - Decision Making (Lai, Lucy)
Section 28890 [A00]

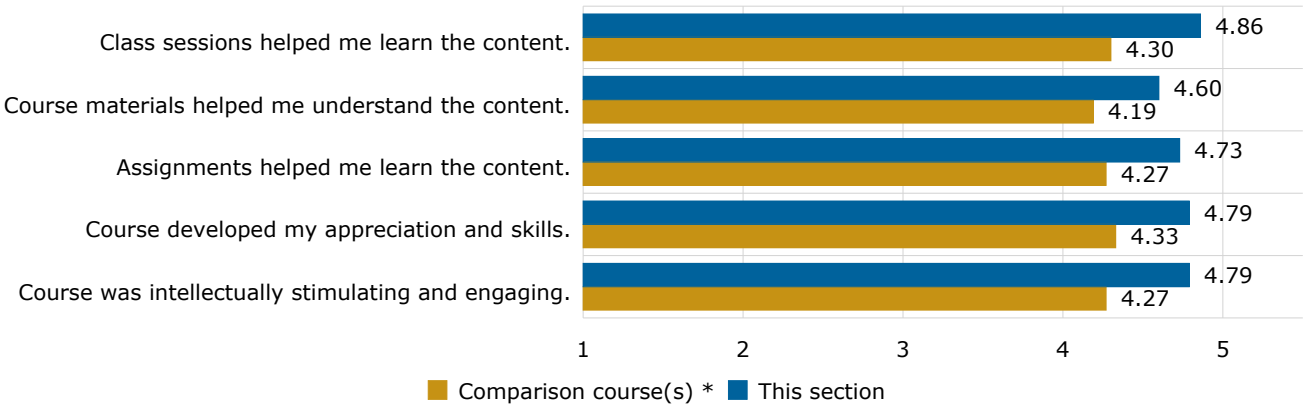
Enrollment: 114
Responses: 72 (63.16% response rate)

SUMMARY RESULTS

** Comparison courses used: All Cognitive Science Winter 2026 UD courses*

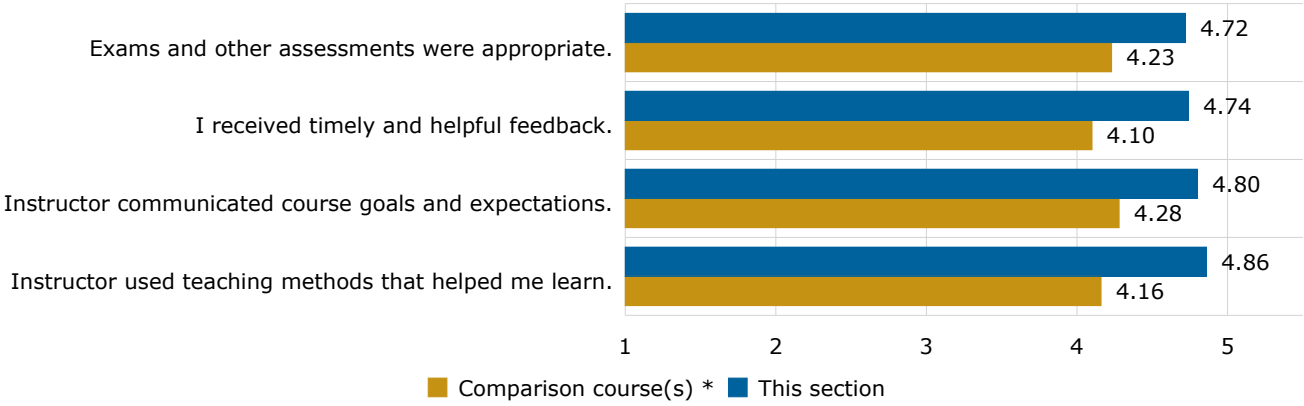
Student Learning

Class Mean: 4.75 (Strongly Agree) **Comparison Mean:** 4.27 (Agree)



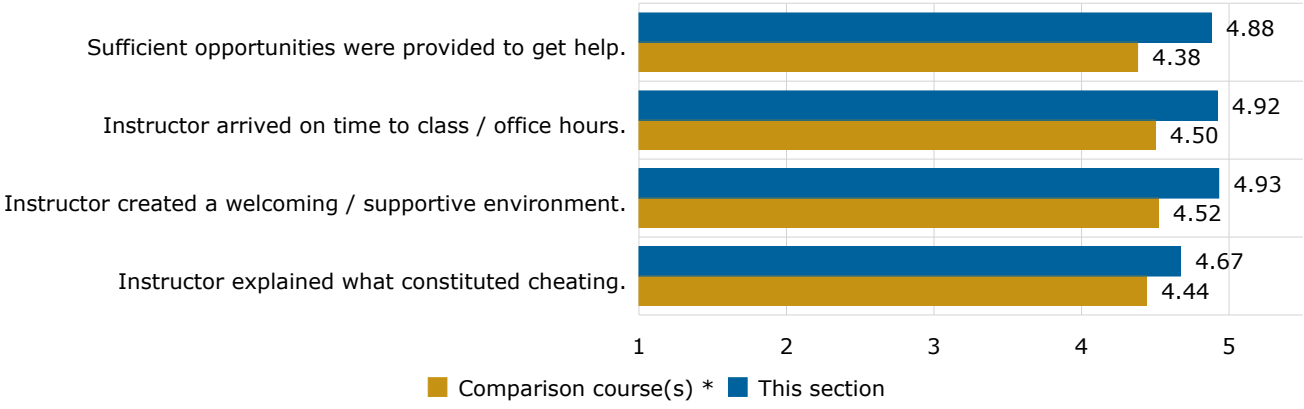
Course Structure

Class Mean: 4.78 (Strongly Agree) **Comparison Mean:** 4.19 (Agree)

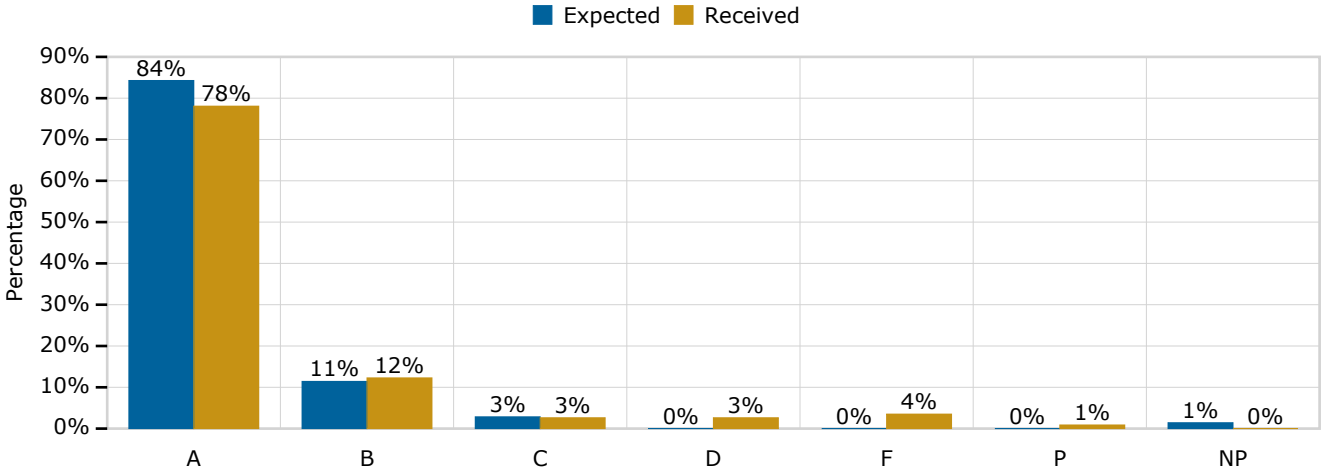


Class Environment

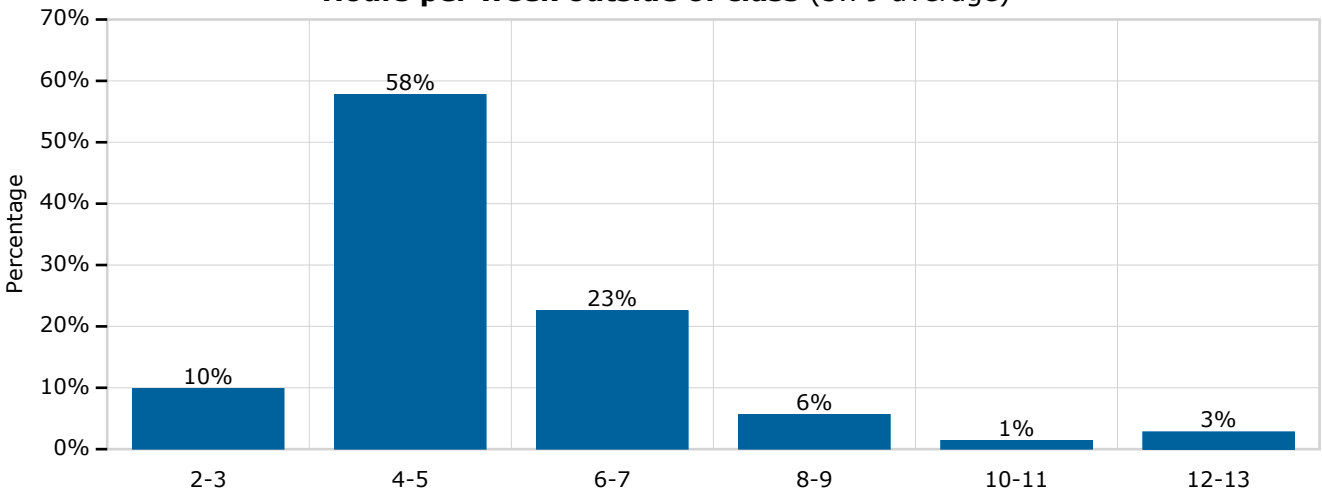
Class Mean: 4.85 (Strongly Agree) **Comparison Mean:** 4.46 (Agree)



Expected Grade (A- average, 3.83, SET respondents) **vs. Grade Received** (B+ average, 3.60, all students)



Hours per week outside of class (5.79 average)



DETAILED RESULTS

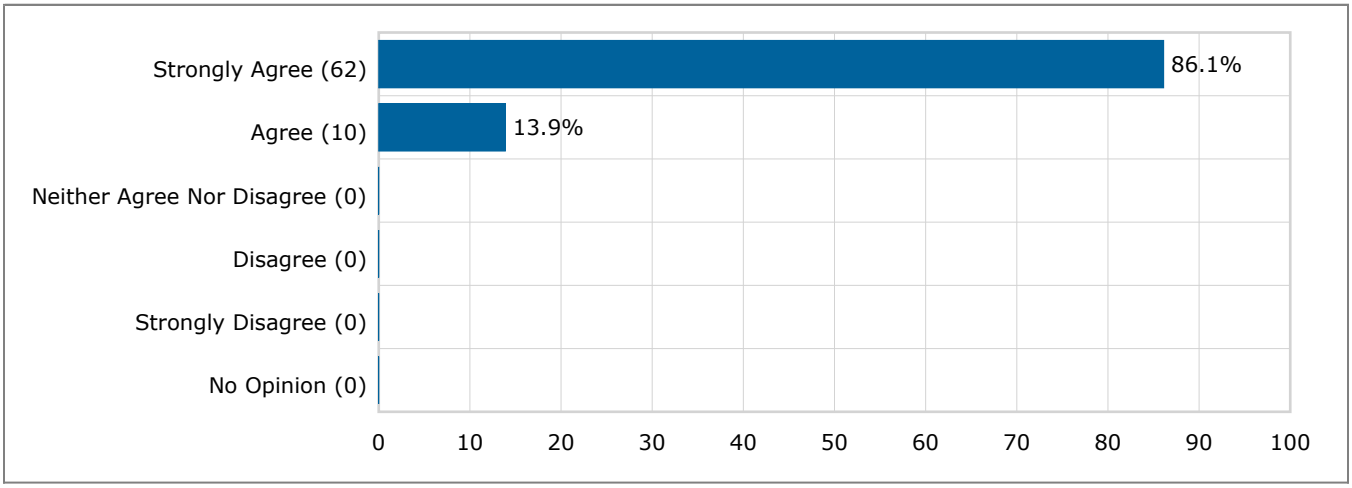
Note: "% Positive" reflects responses of Strongly Agree or Agree; "% Negative" reflects Strongly Disagree or Disagree responses.

Scoring Methodology
A numerical value is assigned to each response in the standard Likert Scale used for evaluations: Strongly Agree (5), Agree (4), Neither Agree Nor Disagree (3), Disagree (2), Strongly Disagree (1). Responses marked "No Opinion/Not Applicable" are excluded from mean calculations.

Student Learning

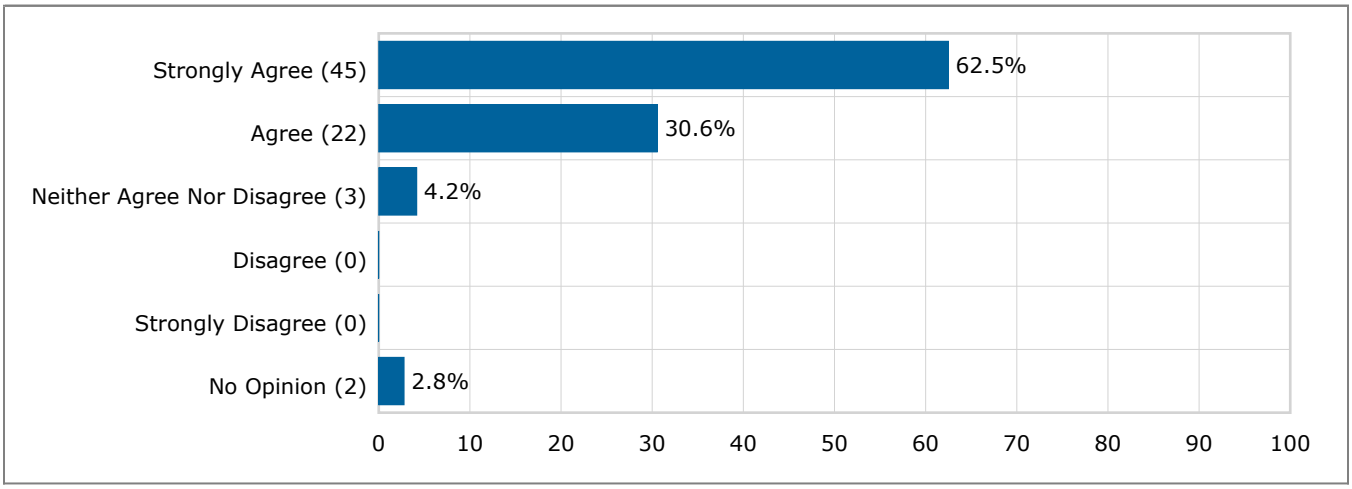
1. **Class sessions** helped me learn the course content.

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
100% Positive	**4.86** ± 0.35 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



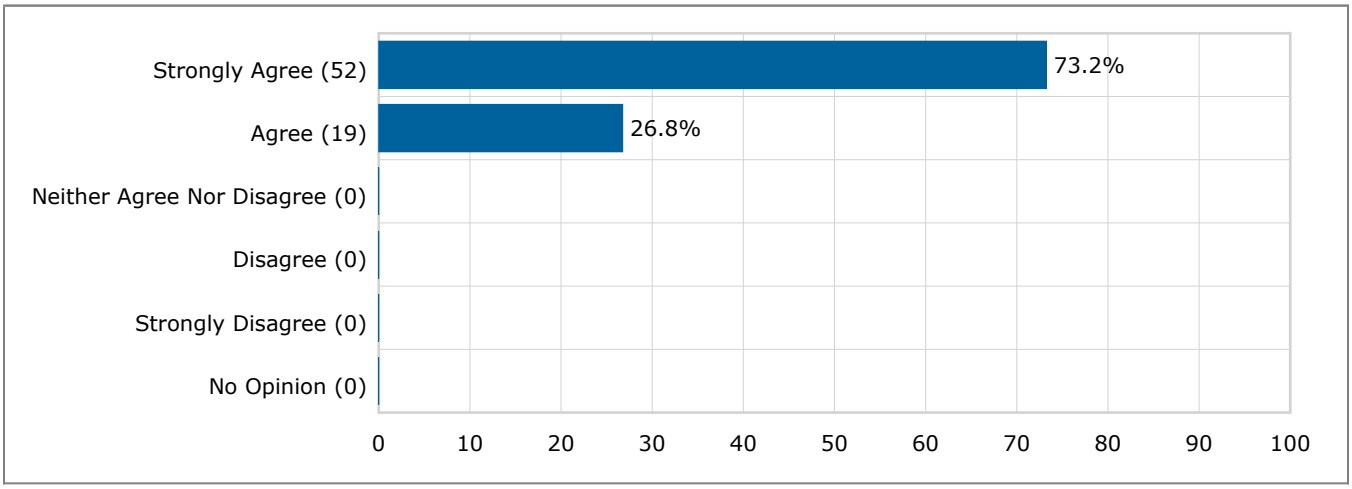
2. **Course readings and other course materials** helped me learn course content.

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
93.1% Positive	**4.6** ± 0.57 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



3. **Assignments** (homework, projects, etc) helped me learn the course content.

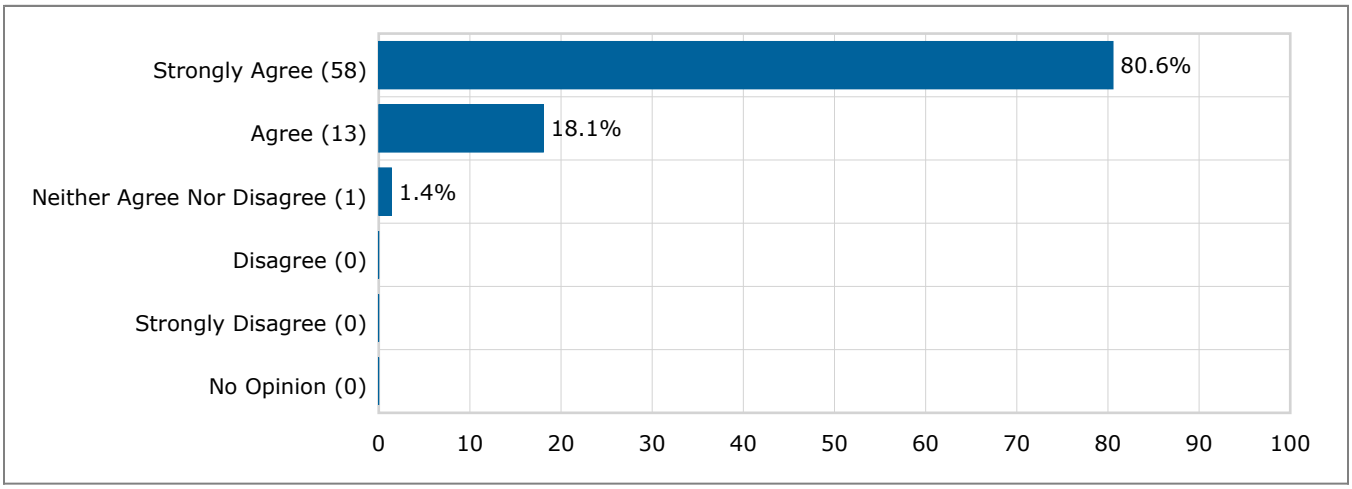
% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
100% Positive	**4.73** ± 0.44 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	71 (98.61%)



No Response: 1

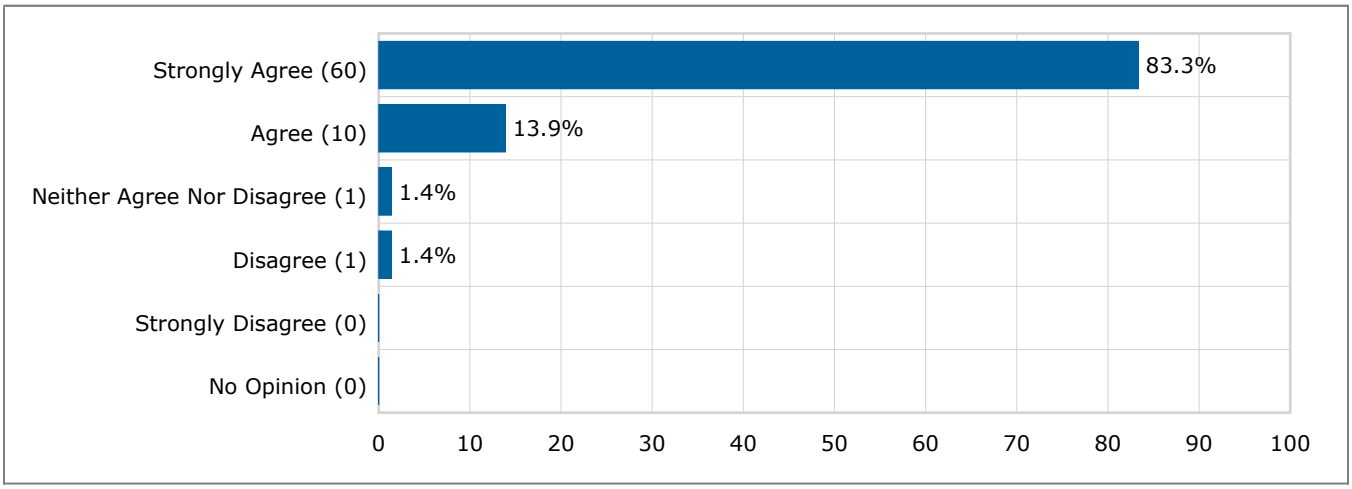
4. The course **developed** my **appreciation** of and **skills** for the subject.

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
98.6% Positive	**4.79** ± 0.44 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



5. The course was **intellectually stimulating and engaging**.

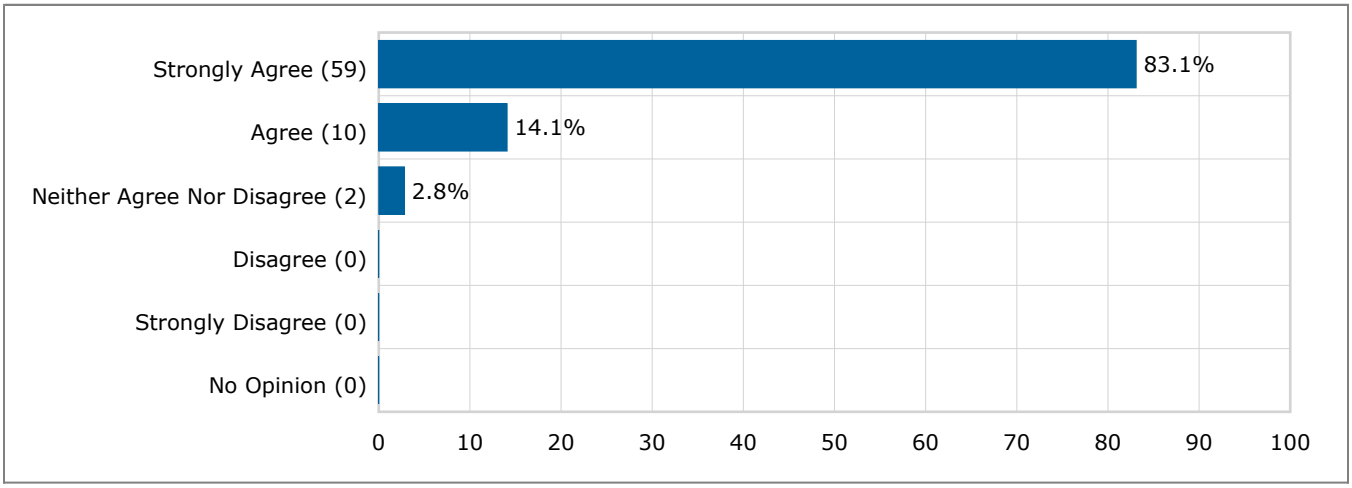
% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
97.2% Positive 1.4% Negative	**4.79** ± 0.53 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



Course Structure

6. The instructor effectively communicated **course goals**, learning **outcomes**, and **expectations**.

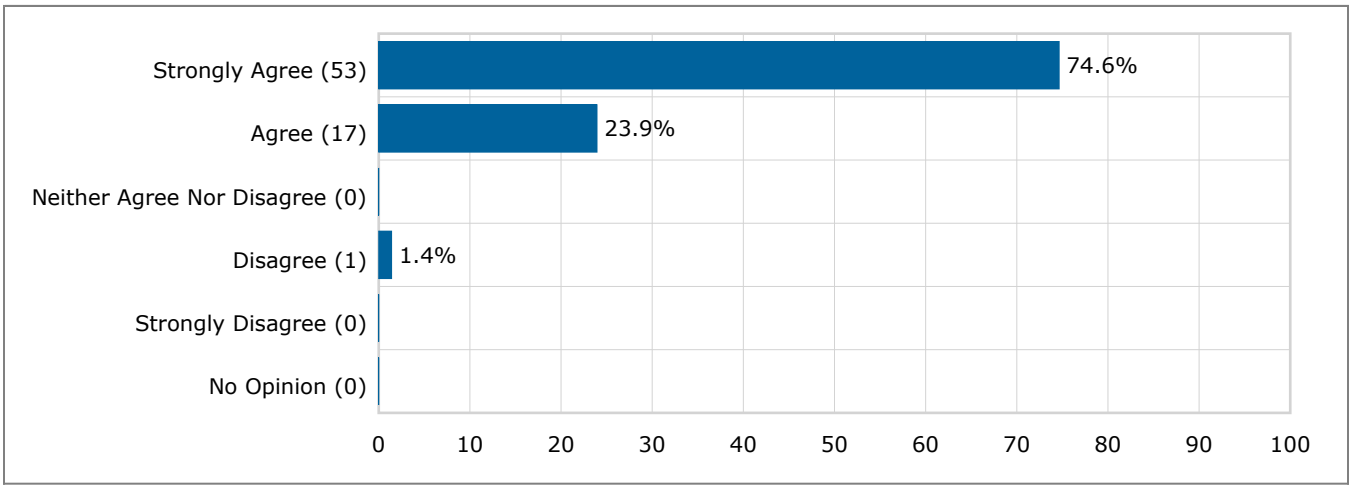
% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
97.2% Positive	**4.8** ± 0.46 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	71 (98.61%)



No Response: 1

7. **Exams and other assessments** (essays, projects, etc) were an appropriate measure of course learning outcomes.

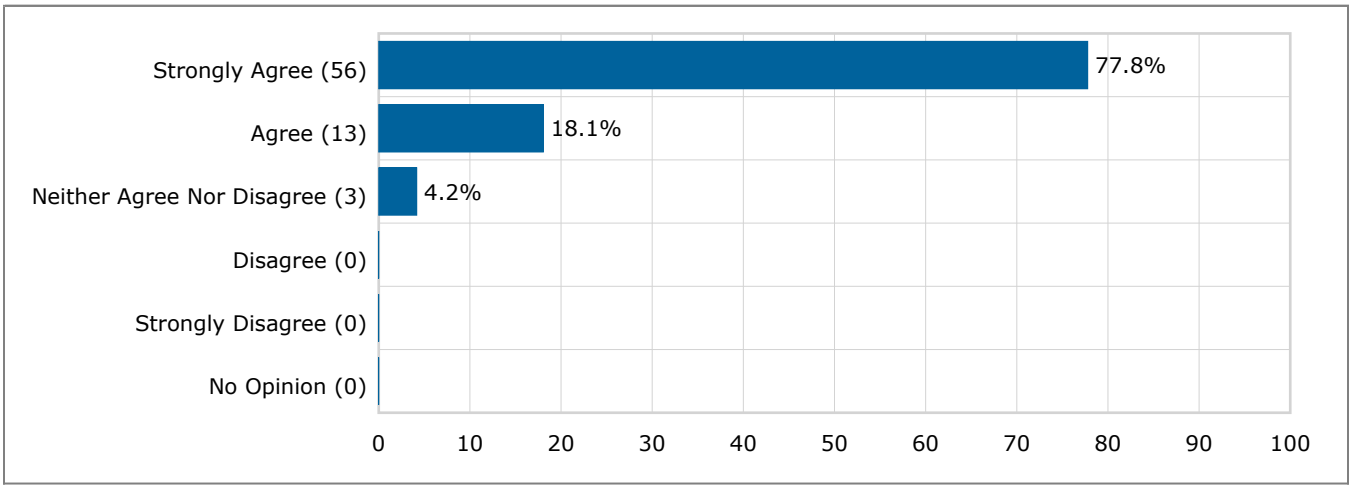
% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
98.6% Positive 1.4% Negative	**4.72** ± 0.54 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	71 (98.61%)



No Response: 1

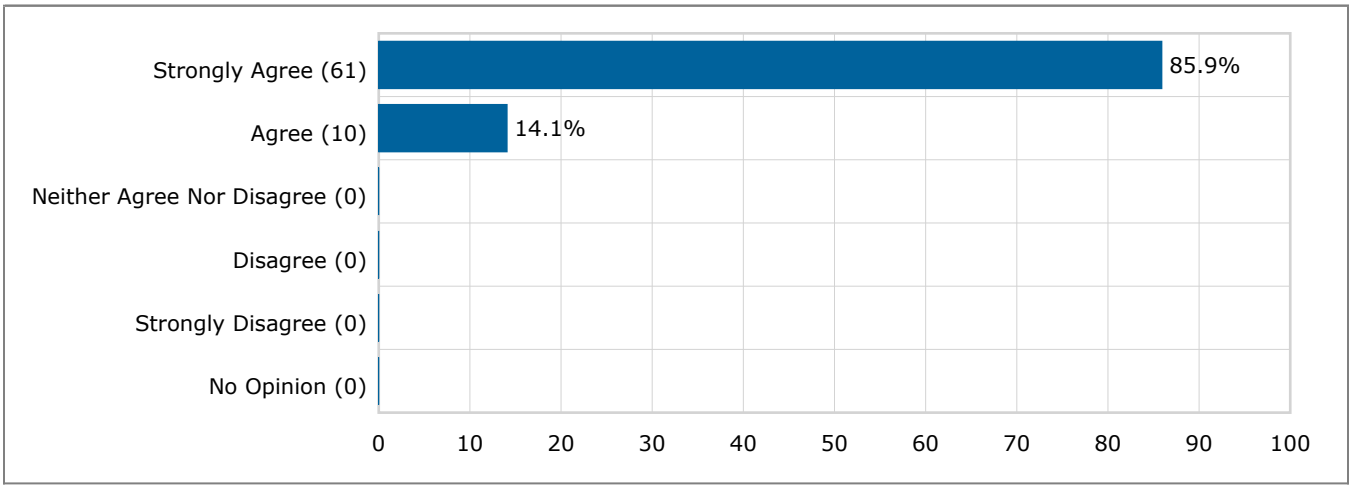
8. I received **timely and helpful feedback** in this course.

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
95.8% Positive	**4.74** ± 0.53 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



9. The instructor incorporated **teaching methods** that helped me learn.

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
100% Positive	**4.86** ± 0.35 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	71 (98.61%)

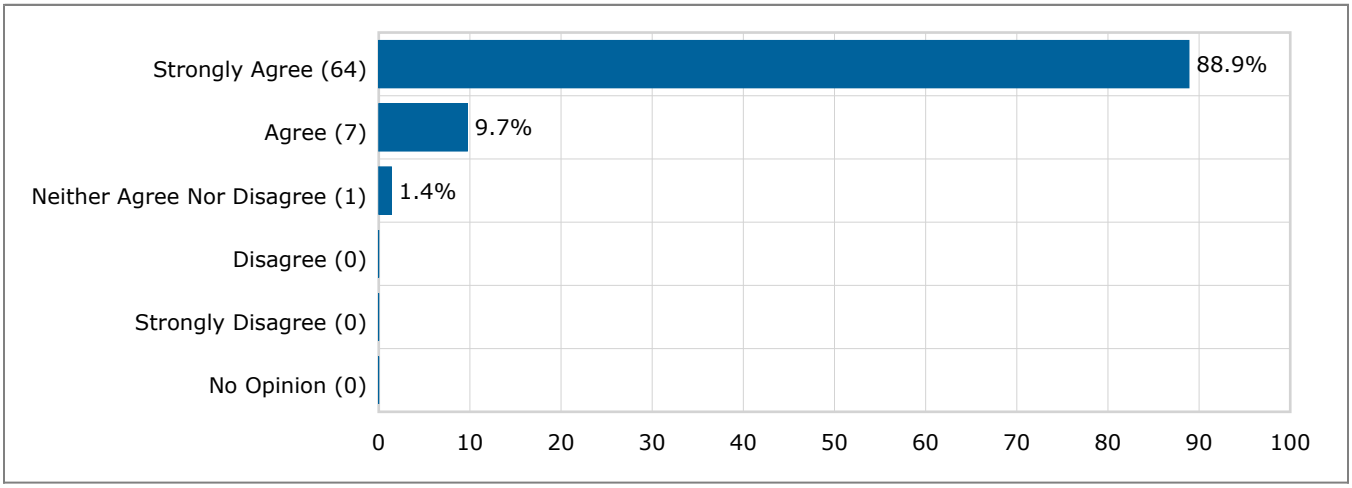


No Response: 1

Class Environment

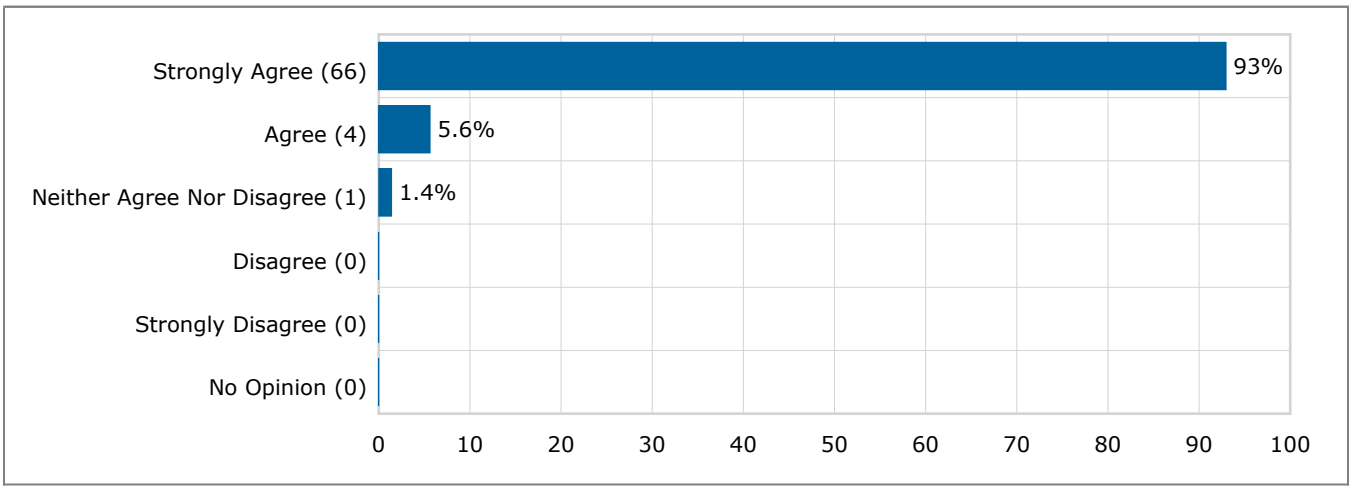
10. There were sufficient **opportunities offered for me to get help** when needed (e.g. established office hours, discussion section, discussion board, etc).

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
98.6% Positive	**4.88** ± 0.37 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



11. The instructor **arrived on time** to class sessions and office hours.

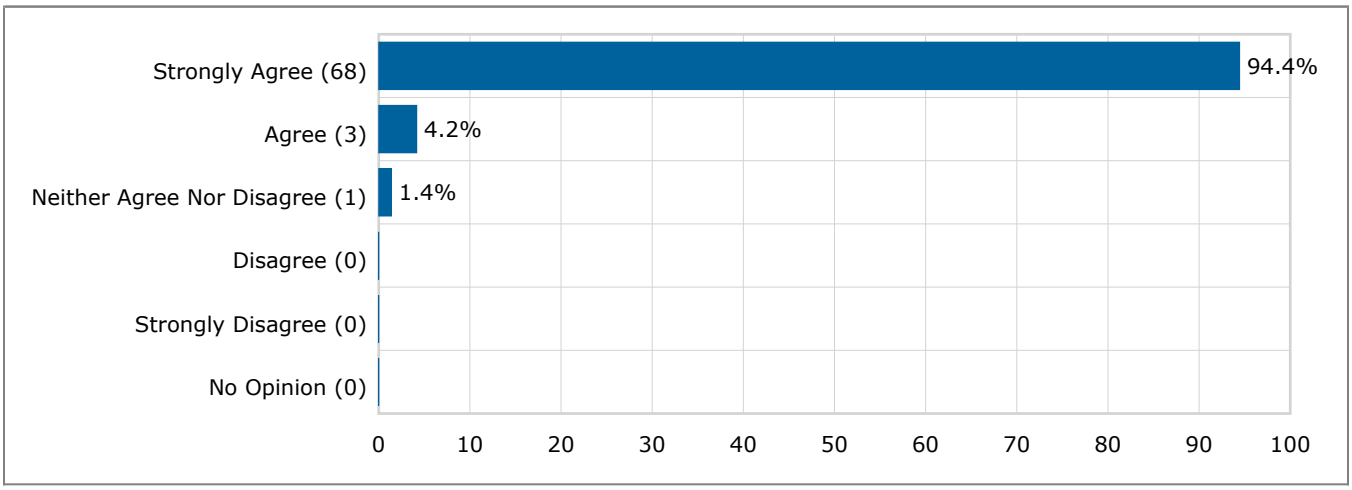
% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
98.6% Positive	**4.92** ± 0.32 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	71 (98.61%)



No Response: 1

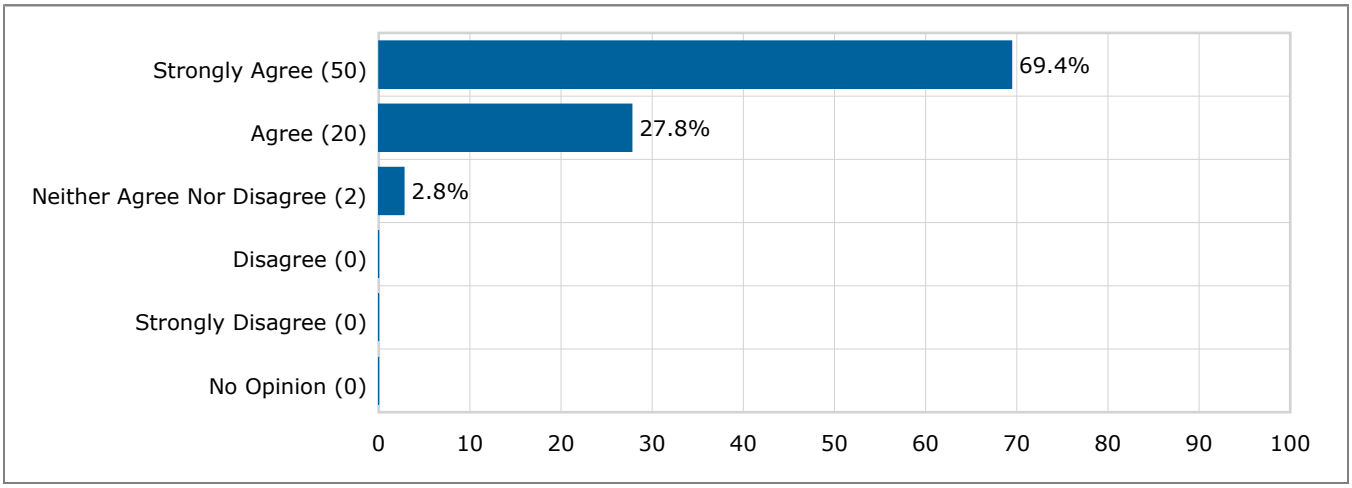
12. The instructor created a **welcoming and supportive learning environment** that valued and supported students from all backgrounds and identities.

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
98.6% Positive	**4.93** ± 0.30 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



13. The instructor explained what constituted cheating in this course and emphasized the importance of **academic integrity**.

% Positive/Negative	Mean (SD)	Median	Response Count
97.2% Positive	**4.67** ± 0.53 (Strongly Agree)	5 (Strongly Agree)	72 (100.00%)



Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that...

14. Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that particularly helped you to engage with the material, learn the material, and/or develop your own critical perspectives on the material.

A lot of the class time was dedicated to discussions about the material which allowed Professor Lai to gauge our understanding and address weaknesses.

Actively incorporated teaching strategies and actively engaged with the class. She would adjust the structure of the class based on what worked best for students.

Always took in feedback. Homework was based on completion rather than correctness. Quizzes every week helped refine understanding, with 3 attempts to curb anxiety.

Class discussions and the lecture structure were extremely invigorating

class discussions!

Different activities and discussion

Her classes were very engaging. When i was confused she would elaborate on the topic to make sure I understood what was being explained.

Her engaging lecture style, with asking students for participation during lecture.

I enjoyed the welcoming environment she fostered and the discussions we would lead in class. I think these discussions were the part of the course that helped me learn most.

I found that the instructor's welcoming and collaborative environment made for one of the better learning experiences I've had on campus. It allowed me to more frequently connect and discuss with others which I believe is crucial for the field of Cognitive Science.

I really enjoyed the structure of the course and all the content that was included in it. Professor Lai is an amazing lecturer and included lots of opportunities for class discussion and share out where I got to hear the insights and perspectives of my peers. She kept us engaged with clicker questions and sharing out and valued what we had to say. She always answered any questions we had about the content from her lectures and from the previous weeks quizzes. She made herself available to her students both after class and in many opportunities for office hours. You can tell she really wants to be there for her students and assist in any way she can. Professor Lai is super knowledgable and personable and made the course one of my favorites at UCSD thus far. You can tell she meticulously curates the readings, homework, and lectures to best aid our learning and she is very intentional with the planning of the course. She is also incredibly nice and created a positive environment in the classroom.

i really enjoyed the webclicker discussions!

I really liked how professor Lai built on the material throughout the quarter, reminded us during lecture about the progress we've made and how structured her class is (course website and documents). Professor Lai gave us the confidence to choose any topic of our own interest for course project by providing support every step of the way.

I really liked the encouragement to talk with others in the class and all of the class discussions we had. also incentivizing participation with snacks was awesome especially for a class at that time

In-class discussions, homework and quizzes that were directly correlated with learning material (written well), overall structure of the course, case study examples in lecture

Present in discus to help out students for project

Prof was super flexible with adaptive teaching and was dedicated to adjusting the class structure etc to help students learn more deeply and critically. Also amazingly charismatic, used topics and examples that really relate to college students when possible and course structure was very discussion based which also kind of built a community within the class.

Professor Lai is an amazing professor in the way she teaches and carries herself. She cares about students, is able to connect with them well, and has a great grading mentality.

Professor Lai made the class a really welcoming and engaging environment. The class content was incredibly stimulating and kept me wanting to go to class. The class structure is designed well in that there are opportunities to have discussions in class and contribute your takeaways from lectures/thoughts. Assignments and coursework was interesting and built on lectures. It felt like content I was learning I was applying. Class discussions especially helped with allowing me to apply the new content immediately. I've taken alot away from the course. The class content allows you to reflect more on your decisions and thought process. It makes it more intentional because you understand what really goes down when you make a decision. To be able to take a class and apply that knowledge to your own practical, everyday life is not something you can say about every class however, I can confidentally say COGS 180 and Professor Lai exceeded my expectations in that.

Professor Lai was incredibly friendly and enthusiastic at every moment, and creating that environment was priceless when it came to engaging with what she was saying. The topics were also incredibly interesting as a whole, and I feel like these ideas can be incorporated in my life.

Professor Lai wove together the economics, neuroscience, psychology, and disease models of decision-making into an interconnected and engaging story. The lectures build on each other and I felt that we got both depth and breadth.

Professor Lai's engaging teaching style, policy on grading (where the goal is to assess LEARNING not instill stress and anxiety), as well as her incredible personality made this course not only enjoyable but one that I walked away more knowledgeable. I would take a class with her again and again!

relatable examples and class discussion times. OMG THE CLASS WEBSITE WAS AMAZING. also the like snacks for participating was fun and webclicker

She is just the best

She seems very passionate and seems to care very much for us as students.

She was really engaging when lecturing

She was very engaged during the lecture, which was very helpful in keeping me interested in the topics covered. She was also very understanding of the circumstances that arose regarding difficulties with homework or deadlines.

The discussions in class was very helpful(it kinda forces us to interact with other classmates and course material also)

Multiple times I was corrected by my classmates about my understanding on a specific topic, and I find that to be very good

The homeworks were really well written, and targeting the main topics very well.

The lectures and course structure are very well designed and easy to follow.

the lectures were very engaging and informative. They were effective in communicating the key principles of decision making for every topic/week. The additional readings were very interesting and supported my learning by giving me a new perspective or take on the subject matter. The homework conceptual questions or first section of the homework were helpful in reinforcing my learning throughout the week.

The many in class discussions with peers was very helpful as we pooled our ideas together before the professor actually went over them. The homework felt long but was very helpful engraving the material into me, as it necessitated lots of work and effort.

the professor made the lectures very interactive and fun

The slides were organized in a way that was very clean and helpful for learning.

The structure of the course being very interactive and discussion focused. It helped to articulate and hear different perspectives.

very engaging lecturer who clearly has passion for content material as well as teaching. made class as fun as class could be

15. Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that were less helpful for your learning. Optionally you may offer constructive suggestions that might improve their effectiveness.

final project was a little unclear to me

For the project, I think it'd be nice if we had more time on them so we can expand it even more.

Her class was very helpful, I have no feedback because her class was always effective.

I feel like maybe one midterm would've helped slightly but otherwise the class was effective as is.

I genuinely have no complaints about this class. When people DID have complaints, Professor Lai was always incredibly receptive to them and created a democratic society where people had the ability to change the status quo.

I think that starting the project much earlier would have been more helpful, especially for those collecting data

I think that there were a lot of changing/moving parts, like with deadlines for the checkpoints, and homeworks which made it kind of difficult to keep track of things, but I know that this is the first time that this course is being offered during a regular quarter and a lot of kinks were being worked out and I am appreciative that these changes were made to accommodate student needs. I don't think this will be much of a problem in the future as this course becomes more established.

I was definitely disappointed with this class. The course description makes it seem more cognitive science oriented. I expected to learn a lot more about decision systems, neuroanatomy, etc. Instead, we only spent brief minutes on these topics. It was very misleading, and I likely would not have taken this class if I had known. This seems like a better class for someone who is interested in economics because of how theory based it was. Professor Lai was great, but the content in this class was not.

Less helpful was not much, maybe it was kinda the same people raising their hands.

long readings sometimes

nothing in mind

Nothing!

Slides were a bit confusing. I think there should be a summary slide at the end (different from takeaways). Concepts weren’t always clear or did not have enough examples.

Some of the early discussions didn't provide much new information, but I think they improved as we shifted to final project work

the homework was pretty long, especially when it had the paper questions. sometimes, i feel like i wasn't sure if i was getting the content/questions right on the homework, especially the ones using google collaborator.

the homework was very heavy and we were given a short period of time. in the future, maybe shortening the homework or giving more time to complete it will help.

the weekly reading of the papers was pretty tiring and daunting considering there's limited exposure to reading academic or research papers throughout undergrad. Although I do believe they were helpful and informative for the topic, I think that there should be reading guides for the papers that are offered to be read.

16. Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that created or interfered with a welcoming learning environment that valued and supported students from all backgrounds and identities.

acknowledgment of holidays, personal circumstance, and willingness to know more about every student was very obvious. Super personable and approachable. Would take every class offered by Dr. Lai.

Always engaging on every students answer

Always treated us the same and asked if we needed help, made that connection

Dr. Lai is so sweet and welcoming! you can tell that she really cares about teaching and helping students. i wish that i wasn't graduating now so that i could connect with her more and take another one of her classes

Everyone gets an opportunity to share smth about themselves in the warmup activity.

Everything her smile her kindness and she always checked in on us

extremely personable - very few professors feel like we can just go up and yap with them. it's not scary at all with her as the professor.

office hours

Professor Lai was consistently engaged with the students in her class personally, listening to feedback and updating material in accordance with class. She personally assisted me in a big way by providing me with connections for grad school opportunities.

Professor Lai was incredibly supportive of her students. She made an effort to learn and remember as many names as she could and would often chat about and highlight student accomplishments outside of the scope of the class. She was very receptive to feedback given in the weekly feedback forms and changed course policy midway through the term to reflect popular opinion.

Professor Lai's energy in class and the general vibe that she created were always welcoming. It felt like a very comfortable place to be, rather than a stuffy lecture that makes me want to sleep. It's the most engaged I've been with a class in my 3 years at UCSD.

Professor Lai's welcoming energy and genuine desire to help students learn created an environment that supported students

She always made discussions fun and helped us feel welcome by making different prompts each discussion during class.

She gave many opportunities to interact with others during lectures with questions that were really engaging.

she had a welcoming attitude and made encouraged everyone to participate in discussion in a way that felt safe to participate.

She was a very open and supportive professor that always wanted to hear what students had to think, and rewarded participation in class.

She was very welcoming of everyone and always encouraged people attending her office hours, which was very beneficial to answering questions and making people feel comfortable.

The course was very collaborative and welcoming each lecture.

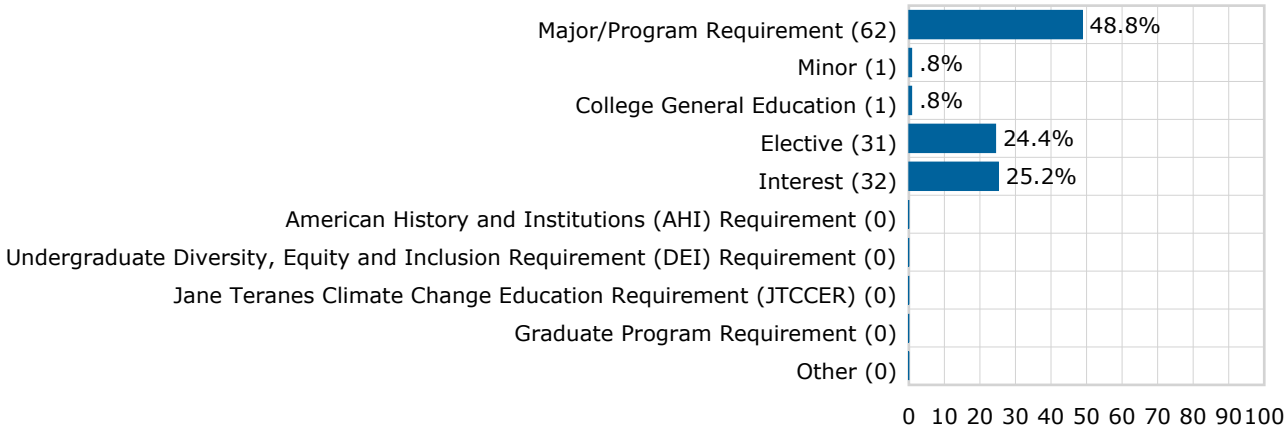
The professor supported in class discussions with other students, encouraged participation with snacks and made students feel comfortable with sharing.

There were opportunites every class for her students to share thoughts and perspectives and you could tell she values feedback from her students.

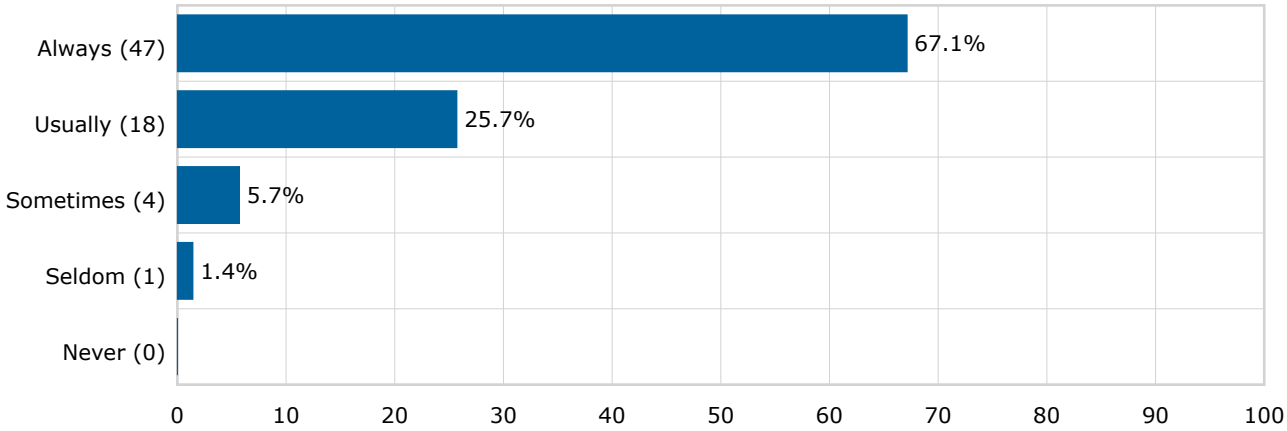
Welcoming and comfortable space. The professor always offered discussion time and greeted students. Shared holidays that were happening-- inclusive with different holidays

Student Participation

17. What was/were your reason(s) for taking this course?

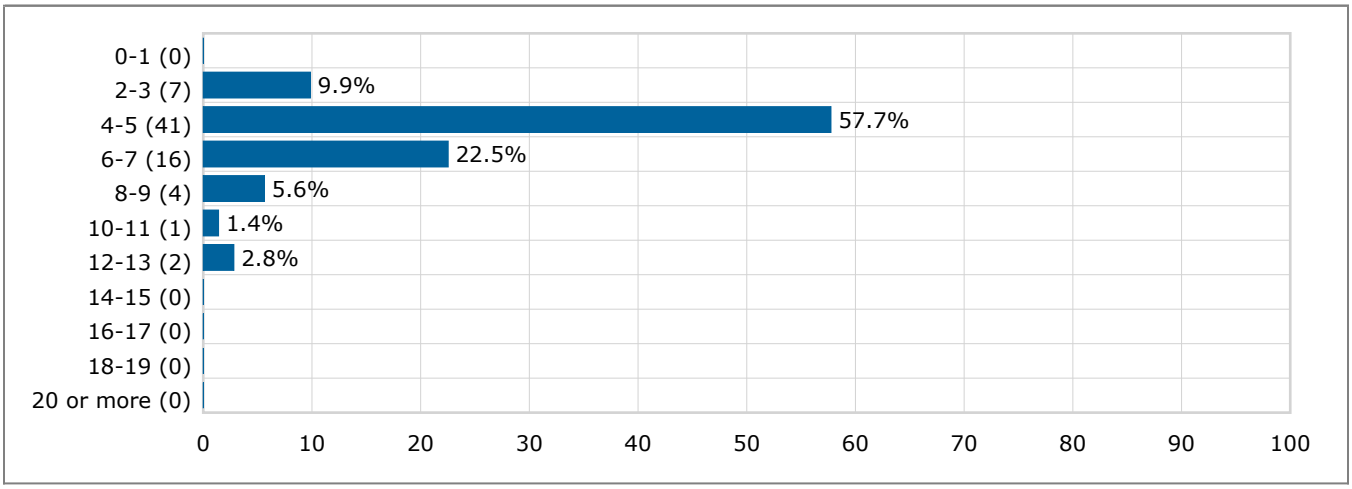


18. How often did you attend class and/or engage with course materials?



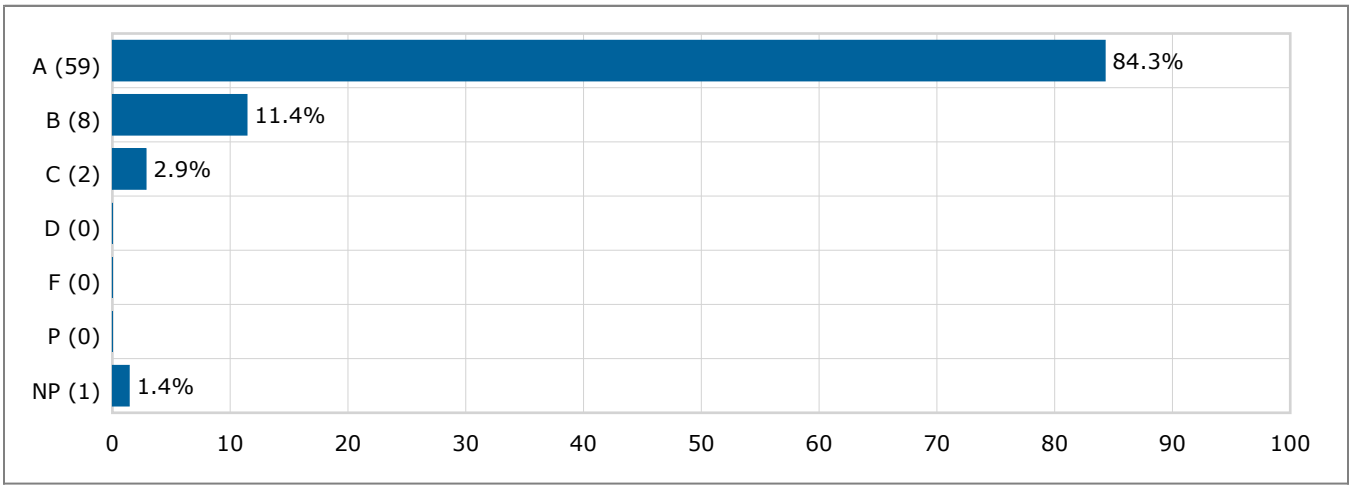
No Response: 2

19. Hours per week of work outside of class



No Response: 1

20. Expected grade in the course



No Response: 2

Additional Feedback

21. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience in the course?

absolutely love professor lai!!!

Amazing professor! So full of joy and life.

I really enjoyed this course and thought professor Lai did a great job.

I really really enjoyed this course and would recommend any of Professor Lai's classes to any student.

Interesting class and Prof. Lai is supportive as always! I will always recommend taking her class!

it has been so fun to have prof lai as a professor! her office hours were always fun and i've felt engaged in her class most days. again, she is very personable which makes it easier to ask for help about the class and other things as well. she's very clear about things from the start and does a good job of upholding them - but she is also VERY receptive to feedback that we give through the google forms. i REALLY appreciate how much she listens to her students to improve the class and their experience. i've loved having her as a professor and am a little sad that my major doesn't align with many of the classes she'll be teaching (ML + AI focused i believe). thanks for everything prof lai!

looved being in this class, professor lai is such a great addition to the cogsci team at UCSD. i think she really represents adapting teaching and learning in our current day and age so that her as a professor, isnt just sticking to whats been done before but using what works, and exploring new ways to motivate students and engage learning for such a wildly different audience than when most professors here were undergraduates.

Lovely class, professor design this course perfectly. You were able to learn from a fun and interesting environment. Lots of interaction and touch base on lot of topics. 100/100 for the class design. Assignments and everything were designed to help students better understand the material.

Professor Lai is a great professor, and I hope that she teaches more classes that I have to take in the future so I can experience her teaching once again.

Professor Lai is my favorite professor

Professor Lai is really adept at speaking to undergraduates in a way that makes them excited about the material. It's also clear that she understands and advocates for her students.

Professor Lai is the best professor I had this quarter, and one of the best I've had in COGS

Professor Lai is the BEST!!!!!!

She da ??!!!

> She was a great professor and her teaching strategy was very effective.

> super fun class

> THANK YOU
> THANK YOU
> THANK YOU
> THANK YOU
> THANK YOU

> The best class I've ever taken!

> The instructor was very transparent each week and understood the needs of the class as a collective. Overall, the instructor facilitated one of my favourite environments and I wish I had attended more office hours.

> This was a super engaging class! I was really impressed by Prof. Lai's acceptance and implementation of feedback, it really seems like she values every one of her students and the perspective they bring.

The data and comments provided in this report are unfiltered and unedited, and do not necessarily reflect the opinions of instructors, the teaching department, Academic Affairs, or UC San Diego. Responses and comments are made available without auditing or editing, and they may not be modified or deleted, to ensure that each evaluator has an opportunity to express their opinion.

Confidential support for reading and interpreting student feedback is available through the Teaching and Learning Commons. Click here to schedule a one-on-one consultation, or email engagedteaching@ucsd.edu.

As a reminder, you will have an opportunity to provide additional context and/or commentary for campus reviewers as part of your teaching statement at the time of your academic review (subject to applicable academic review procedures, policies, and labor agreements).

If you feel that comments constitute harassment or discrimination, then please file a report with the Office for the Prevention of Harassment and Discrimination (OPHD). Because these comments are provided anonymously, it is unlikely that any action can be taken. However, OPHD will record and review these reports in order to assess whether SET comments are a cause for concern.